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Assignment 1: Identifying the business idea

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The growing demand for English proficiency in the globalized workforce has led to a surge in mobile-assisted language learning. However, a significant gap remains between theoretical vocabulary acquisition and the ability to understand authentic spoken language. Intermediate learners, particularly those at the B1 and B2 levels, often struggle to transition from structured textbooks to consuming native content such as movies and series. While viewing audiovisual content is recognized as a powerful method for incidental vocabulary acquisition, the user experience is frequently disrupted by the need to consult external dictionaries or the cognitive overload caused by standard subtitles. This project introduces CineLearn, a mobile application designed to resolve these friction points by transforming passive video consumption into an active, context-rich learning process through gesture-based interaction and automated content curation.

The primary challenge CineLearn addresses is the cognitive conflict known as the split-attention effect during media consumption. Empirical studies demonstrate that when learners are presented with simultaneous auditory and textual input (video with subtitles), visual processing often dominates, which can impede the development of listening skills if not managed correctly (Bird & Williams, 2002). Existing market solutions fail to adequately address this trade-off. Desktop browser extensions like Language Reactor offer similar functionality but are confined to non-mobile environments, limiting accessibility. Conversely, popular gamified applications such as Duolingo rely on synthetic, decontextualized sentences. CineLearn solves this by offering a minimalist streaming interface where subtitles are hidden by default to ensure full immersion, bridging the gap between desktop utility and mobile accessibility.

The core technological innovation is the gesture-based double-tap mechanism. When a user encounters an unintelligible phrase, a quick double-tap on the screen pauses the video and reveals the transcript for only the last spoken segment. Unlike traditional video players that require precise seeking on a timeline, the gesture control in CineLearn reduces the physical and cognitive load of interaction. Furthermore, the application prioritizes second language acquisition by offering contextual definitions in English. Research by Webb (2005) indicates that learning vocabulary within meaningful sentence contexts significantly improves both recall and the ability to use words productively compared to isolated glosses.

Technologically, the application integrates a Spaced Repetition System to combat the forgetting curve. While traditional tools use static flashcards, CineLearn utilizes deterministic backend algorithms to automatically slice saved vocabulary into a dynamic vertical video feed. By leveraging timestamp metadata, the system extracts the exact video segment where the word was spoken. Experimental evidence from Karpicke and Roediger (2008) proves that repeated retrieval practice, especially when spaced out, dramatically increases long-term retention compared to mere restudying. Additionally, Stockwell (2010) found that mobile-based vocabulary activities lead to higher engagement frequencies due to their portability. The content strategy relies on aggregating media from open educational sources and allowing user-generated uploads, ensuring a diverse library suitable for intermediate learners.

To ensure economic viability, the project will operate on a Freemium business model, which is empirically proven to be effective for digital goods with low marginal distribution costs (Liu et al., 2014). The free tier will provide access to the player but will enforce a daily limit of five saved words. Conversely, a premium subscription, priced at approximately \$4.99 per month, will remove this restriction, unlocking unlimited vocabulary storage, the personalized video review mode, and offline capabilities. This pricing strategy is tailored to the purchasing power of students and young professionals in the CIS region, making high-quality contextual learning accessible while ensuring recurring revenue.

In conclusion, CineLearn represents a shift from passive entertainment to active cognitive engagement. By evaluating the limitations of current market offerings, specifically the lack of mobility in browser extensions and the lack of context in gamified apps, our team has developed a solution that prioritizes user flow. The integration of gesture controls and automated content curation provides a scalable solution to the persistent problem of the language barrier in authentic media consumption.

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